

HOW YOU TEST (LIKE DIGIT IN THE TEST CENTRE)

After buying the tablet of your choice, you can test it the way we do by following these tests. On performing these tests, you'll be able to get a clearer picture of where your chosen tablet stands among other tablets.

Display

We ourselves start with the same test of checking color shift in a tablet display by using the same methods we suggested in the previous section. We do this test in various lighting conditions as well as at various brightness settings which a tablet may encounter during the course of its lifetime. After that, we use tests like the browser-based lagom.nl and in case of Android devices Antutu's own display test to get a better picture of what the display can achieve. We compare the concluding results with segment toppers at the moment and this helps us to quantify the results further.

Performance

To test the performance of a new tablet we follow the same test regime we employ for smartphones. When the device is fresh out of the box, we load all the synthetic benchmarks we use which are Antutu, Geekbench, PC Mark for Android, 3D Mark benchmarks and GFX Bench. We do these benchmarks tests when the tablet is fresh out of the box since this gives us the most accurate benchmark result the tablet could achieve.

Antutu benchmark gives combined points on the performance. It also features a screen test benchmark which we have mentioned earlier in the display section. Another important number Antutu provides is the number for read and write operations the internal storage can perform.

On the other hand, GeekBench 3 provides a split score for single core and Multi core. These scores when compared to other devices we have tested in the past give us the ground to assess the phone on its multitasking abilities.

GPU tests like GFX bench provide a lot of test result which assess the on-board GPU but the scores we look for are Manhattan and T-Rex tests. However, all these synthetic benchmarks are readily available on the Android platform only with the exception of Antutu

and GFX Bench which are also available on the Windows platform. While none of the above mentioned benchmarks is available for iOS. Thus we move on to real life tests.

We use a tablet generally for more than a week to assess and review the device. In this time we use the device extensively by loading it with apps and using it as a daily driver. There have been instances of devices which would run circles around synthetic benchmarks but would either heat up in day to day tasks or just aren't good enough to handle real world multitasking. If you already own or just bought a new tablet, you can check these methods yourself and assess your tablet.

Camera

For cameras, we follow our standard camera procedure. We click pictures in four lighting conditions – outside in visible sunlight, in yellow light, indoors in fluorescent light and in low light conditions. We take our standard shots of things and a colour chart which are kept in unaltered lighting conditions. These pictures are then transferred to a computer, on which we go into the details of each picture at 100 percent crop to check various distortions the image might have.

Battery

All these heavy duty benchmarking tests and real-world usage takes its toll on the tablet's battery. So, to assess the battery we run an in-house battery test in which we first clear all background activity and then play a 1080p test video with Wi-Fi on and with display on full brightness. We play this for one hour exactly, after which we note down the battery drop. Remember that most good tablets would register less than a 10 percent battery drop in this test.

In case of Android tablets, we also run PC Mark battery test and Geekbench 3 battery test.

Calling capability

Calling capable tablets are checked by making calls. We check if the voice quality is accurate on both ends. We prefer that the other person can hear you clearly even if you're making the call from an environment with a noisy background.

Windows 10. However, if you want a mix of great applications – ranging from games and lifestyle apps to productivity apps – nothing beats the iPad with its iOS. iOS currently provides the most complete app ecosystem in the market with Android very close behind.

SoC

A SoC or System on Chip is the brain of your tablet. These small system on chips generally carry the processor, GPU and radio antennas such as Wi-Fi and cellular among other components. As a rule of thumb, SoCs with quad-core processors or processors with more cores are generally better than dual-core or single core ones. To ease your decision, the current crop of SoCs



Tablet with detachable keyboard

(at least performance wise) has plateaued enough to take care of audio, video and browsing quite efficiently. However, when it comes to resource-intensive tasks like gaming, the difference makes itself evident.

While the SoC you would require is subjective to the task at hand, you can always find out which SoC is better depending on how new it is or what kind of microarchitecture its processor features. Talking about microarchitectures, all major SoC manufacturers use ARM processor architecture. Currently, the performance charts are ruled by NVIDIA's Denver chip which implements a custom version of ARMv8-A architecture. This architecture is capable of running 64-bit applications. ARM's Cortex A72, A57 and A53 also fall in the same 64-bit category. And the Cortex-A17, A12, A15, A7, A5, A9, A8 implement the ARMv7-A architecture which fall in the 32-bit category.